



TIPS & TRICKS

Know your commands

Often, we need to know which command is packed in which rpm package. Here is a tip that will help you get to know the package name. Let us look at an example in which we need to know the name of the package that contains the `ssh` command.

```
$which ssh
/usr/bin/ssh
```

```
$rpm -qf /usr/bin/ssh
openssh-clients-5.2p1-31.fc12.i686
```

In the above commands, we get the location of `ssh` by running `which` and then the rpm package name containing `ssh` is outputted by the second command.

Also, we can combine both commands in one and get the desired output, as follows:

```
$rpm -qf `which ssh`
openssh-clients-5.2p1-31.fc12.i686
```



Note: Please be aware that the above tip may not output as desired for command *aliases*.

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Encrypt a filesystem

Anyone being able to access your filesystem and data without your knowledge destroys your privacy and is a threat to confidentiality. So, we need a method by which both can be secured. One solution is to encrypt the filesystem and enable data privacy. To do this, follow the steps shown below:

1. Create a new partition with `fdisk`.
2. Run the command given below before mounting the device:

```
# cryptsetup luksFormat /dev/sdaN
```

...where N is the number assigned to your partition. Press `Enter` to proceed.

WARNING!

```
=====
This will overwrite data on /dev/sbd1 irrevocably.
Are you sure? (Type uppercase yes):
```

Now type 'YES'.

Enter LUKS passphrase:

Verify passphrase:

Enter the pass phrase and press `Enter` to complete.

If you try the above on a mounted device, you will get an error as shown below. So do remember to unmount the device before attempting the steps mentioned above.

```
Cannot format device /dev/sda9 which is still in use.
```

3. Now, type in the following command:

```
# cryptsetup luksOpen /dev/sdaN name
```

Here, *name* is the mapping name for the device.

The above command unlocks the encrypted volume `/dev/sdaN` as `/dev/mapper/name` after you enter the correct decryption password.

4. Create an ext4 filesystem on the decrypted volume by issuing the following command:

```
# mkfs -t ext4 /dev/mapper/name
```

5. Create the directory mount point and mount the filesystem using the following command: